

Academy Regulations

Rhythm Games Academy

1 October 2026

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This English version is a reference translation. In the event of any discrepancy, the Japanese version prevails.

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Academy Charter

Rhythm games have developed distinctive techniques and cultures over their long history. Countless players have accumulated knowledge and skills up to the present day. These activities continue to deepen and expand, and demand for scholarly and cultural inquiry into rhythm games continues to grow.

Rhythm Games Academy was established as an academic fan community that brings together knowledge, techniques, and cultures relating to rhythm games, conscious of its mission to carry forward and develop this rich body of work. The Academy pledges to support its members' independent activities, including research, creation, courses, and reflection, and to contribute to the development of rhythm game culture as a whole through free and open exchange and inquiry.

To fulfill these missions together with its members, the Academy hereby adopts this Charter.

Article 1. Rhythm Games Academy is an academic fan community whose permanent mission is to gather, pass on, and develop all intellectual and cultural heritage relating to rhythm games. It respects each member's inquiry and creativity, and regards sharing the results with rhythm game culture as a whole as its reason for existing.

Article 2. On the basis of academic freedom, Rhythm Games Academy respects members' free and independent activities as its guiding principle. Regardless of the form or subject of activities, including research, creation, courses, and reflection, it supports equally the inquiry of everyone who wishes to engage independently with rhythm games. It believes that the exchange of diverse perspectives and interests produces richer knowledge.

Article 3. Rhythm Games Academy must respect all members as individuals and treat them equally. Skill level, years of experience, and achievements do not establish a personal hierarchy among members. Members engage with one another as equals from their respective positions and respect one another's knowledge and activities.

2. Members have a duty to respect one another's freedom and maintain healthy order within the community.

Article 4. Rhythm Games Academy opens its doors to everyone who wishes to engage independently with rhythm games and can comply with the Academy's rules. Partici-

pation in activities within the Academy is a matter of each member's free choice, and all forms of participation are equally welcome.

Article 5. Rhythm Games Academy provides places and opportunities for members to pursue inquiry on a continuing basis. It maintains an environment for presenting, discussing, and preserving their work, and supports this foundation regardless of the field of inquiry or form of activity. This environment is a shared resource of all members, and the Academy must continually endeavor to improve it.

Article 6. Rhythm Games Academy regards it as an important responsibility to preserve the results of members' activities on a continuing basis, with due regard for members' rights, and to pass them on to future generations as part of rhythm game culture's heritage. Through members' courses and research activities, it passes the knowledge of earlier generations to the next and maintains continuity in scholarly activity within the Academy.

Article 7. Rhythm Games Academy seeks to sustain its activities over the long term, beyond any temporary burst of enthusiasm. It maintains accumulated knowledge and organizational autonomy so that its mission can be carried forward despite changes in membership and the times. It aims to become a lasting cultural community within the rhythm game community.

Article 8. The Management of Rhythm Games Academy consists of the Director and other officeholders specified in the Academy's rules. Management bears responsibility for administering the Academy and manages its affairs in accordance with the principles of this Charter. Those who constitute Management are themselves members and are bound by this Charter. The details of how Management is selected and of its duties are provided in separately established rules.

Article 9. Any Academy Regulations or acts of Management that conflict with this Charter have no effect to the extent of that conflict, whether in whole or in part.

2. All members have the right to raise an objection to a violation of this Charter by Management.

Article 10. An amendment to this Charter may be proposed by Management or by a joint petition signed by at least one fifth of all members. An amendment requires the support of at least two thirds of the members who participate in the vote and of at least one fifth of all members. Management must confirm that these requirements have been met before putting the amendment into effect. Members must be informed of amendments, and efforts must be made to reflect a broad range of views.

Supplementary provision

This Charter takes effect on 1 August 2026.

History

Adopted on 22 June 2026.

Chapter 1 General Provisions

Article 1. These Regulations establish the necessary provisions concerning the organization and operation of Rhythm Games Academy (hereinafter referred to as the “Academy”) in accordance with the principles of the Academy Charter (hereinafter referred to as the “Charter”).

Article 2. In these Regulations, the following terms have the meanings specified below.

- (1) Student: a person who has acquired Student status under Chapter 4, Article 3.
- (2) Dean: a Student appointed under Chapter 2, Article 3.
- (3) Director: the Dean designated as Director under Chapter 2, Article 4.
- (4) Lecturer: a Student approved under Chapter 6, Article 2.
- (5) officeholder: the Director, a Dean, a Lecturer, or a person holding another office established within the Academy under Chapter 2, Article 2.
- (6) course: a learning activity provided by a Lecturer to Students.
- (7) academic term: a unit used to divide the Academy’s activities, consisting of a six-month period specified in Chapter 3, Article 2.
- (8) regular activity period: a period during which the Academy’s courses and other activities are conducted in their usual form.
- (9) make-up period: a period following the regular activity period for supplementary course sessions within the same academic term.
- (10) recruitment period: a period during which people wishing to become Students are recruited for the next academic term.

Article 3. The members referred to in the Charter are Students.

Article 4. The Management referred to in the Charter consists of the Deans.

Article 5. Guidelines may be established to provide for matters necessary to implement these Regulations and otherwise operate the Academy.

2. Guidelines may not contain provisions contrary to the Charter or these Regulations. Guidelines that conflict with the Charter or these Regulations have no effect.
3. Guidelines may not impose obligations on Students that are not provided for in these Regulations.
4. The Deans adopt, amend, and repeal guidelines.

5. When guidelines concerning Students' activities are adopted, amended, or repealed, the Deans must promptly announce this to Students.

Chapter 2 Management and Organization

Article 1. This chapter establishes the necessary provisions concerning offices required for the Academy's operation, their appointment, and related matters, in accordance with the principles of the Charter.

Article 2. The Academy has a Director and Deans.

2. In addition to the offices specified in the preceding paragraph, the Academy may establish Lecturer positions and other offices.

Article 3. A Student wishing to become a Dean must make a request to the Director.

2. When the Director approves the request referred to in the preceding paragraph, the Director appoints that Student as a Dean.
3. No fixed number of Deans is prescribed.

Article 4. One of the Deans serves as Director.

2. If the office of Director becomes vacant, the Deans determine a successor through consultation.

Article 5. If consultation among the Deans does not produce agreement, or if an urgent decision is required, the Director may decide the matter.

2. The preceding paragraph does not apply to the following matters.
 - (1) Approval under Chapter 6, Article 2 or Chapter 7, Article 6.
 - (2) Matters concerning removal of the Director from office.
3. A decision under paragraph 1 is a procedure for facilitating decision-making among the Deans and does not mean that the Director is superior to other Deans.

Article 6. Officeholders serve without remuneration. They must not receive remuneration or other compensation for performing their duties.

2. The preceding paragraph does not prevent an officeholder from accepting a customary courtesy gift that does not constitute compensation for performing duties.

Article 7. An officeholder who loses Student status automatically loses their status as an officeholder.

Article 8. Matters concerning loss of officeholder status other than those specified in the preceding Article are governed by Chapter 8.

Article 9. The Deans separately establish provisions needed to implement this chapter.

Chapter 3 Academic Terms

Article 1. This chapter establishes the necessary provisions concerning academic terms as units of activity periods for the smooth conduct of the Academy's activities, in accordance with the principles of the Charter.

Article 2. The Academy's academic terms consist of the following periods, recurring every six months.

(1) From 1 April to 30 September.

(2) From 1 October to 31 March of the following year.

2. The regular activity period and make-up period for each academic term in the preceding paragraph are as follows.

(1) For the academic term in item (1) of the preceding paragraph, the regular activity period runs from 1 April to 31 July, and the make-up period from 1 August to 15 August.

(2) For the academic term in item (2) of the preceding paragraph, the regular activity period runs from 1 October to 31 January of the following year, and the make-up period from 1 February to 15 February of the following year.

Article 3. Recruitment periods for the following academic terms are as specified below.

(1) For the academic term in Article 2, paragraph 1, item (1): from 15 February to 15 April.

(2) For the academic term in Article 2, paragraph 1, item (2): from 15 August to 15 October.

2. A recruitment period may continue after the beginning of the regular activity period of the academic term concerned.

Article 4. The first academic term when the Academy begins full course operation is designated "Term #1". Subsequent terms are numbered in order of their start dates, increasing by one each time, regardless of which period in Article 2, paragraph 1 they fall within.

2. The Deans separately establish the start date of the first academic term and other necessary matters.

Article 5. When the Deans determine that unavoidable operational circumstances exist, they may change the periods specified in Articles 2 and 3.

2. When a period is changed under the preceding paragraph, the Deans must promptly announce the change to Students.

Article 6. The Deans separately establish provisions needed to implement this chapter.

Chapter 4 Students

Article 1. This chapter establishes the necessary provisions concerning Student status, joining and leaving the Academy, and other matters relating to membership, in accordance with the principles of the Charter.

Article 2. A person who can comply with these Regulations may become a Student.

2. Notwithstanding the preceding paragraph, a person who does not meet the terms of use of an external service used as a platform for the Academy's activities may not become a Student, because they cannot participate in activities on that service.

Article 3. A person wishing to become a Student must submit the prescribed application and acquires Student status when that application reaches the Academy while it is accepting new applications. No approval or selection is required for the application.

2. Where operational needs require it, the Deans may set a limit on the number of people who newly acquire Student status during each recruitment period specified in Chapter 3, Article 3.
3. When the limit in the preceding paragraph is reached, the Deans must close acceptance of further new applications and promptly announce the time of closure.
4. The limit described in the preceding two paragraphs applies only to people who newly become Students during the recruitment period concerned. It does not limit existing Students' continued membership or the total number of Students.
5. The specific application procedure referred to in paragraph 1 is established separately.

Article 4. Students may freely participate in inquiry activities within the Academy as provided in the Charter.

2. Students must comply with these Regulations and endeavor to maintain order within the community.

Article 5. Once a Student has completed the procedure for joining, their membership continues across academic terms without any procedure to renew it each term.

2. The preceding paragraph does not prevent withdrawal under the following Article or expulsion under Article 7, or other grounds for loss of Student status.

Article 6. A Student may leave the Academy at any time.

Article 7. A Student loses Student status when expelled under Chapter 8.

Article 8. The Deans separately establish provisions needed to implement this chapter.

Chapter 5 Deans

Article 1. This chapter sets out the fundamental principles that Deans must follow in performing their duties, in accordance with the principles of the Charter.

2. Specific procedures concerning the duties of Deans are established separately.

Article 2. Deans are responsible for the Academy's administrative affairs and have a duty to maintain an environment in which Students can continuously pursue the inquiry activities provided for in the Charter.

Article 3. Deans must always recognize that their duties exist to enable and support Students' inquiry activities.

2. Deans must support Students' inquiry activities equally, regardless of their form or subject, and recognize that they are not in a position to judge the relative merits of those activities.

Article 4. The office of Dean is a function assigned for the performance of duties and does not signify personal superiority over Students.

2. Deans perform their duties while retaining Student status and must engage with other Students as equals.

Article 5. A Dean's intervention in Students' activities must be limited to the minimum necessary so as not to unduly restrict the academic freedom provided for in the Charter.

2. Where several means are available, Deans must give preference to those that are less restrictive and easier to reverse or recover from.

3. Deans may exercise their powers only where grounds specified in these Regulations exist and must not use those powers for other purposes.

Article 6. Deans must remain able to explain the reasons for decisions made in the course of their duties.

2. When a Dean makes a decision affecting a Student's rights or interests, the Dean must make the reasons clear to that Student.

Article 7. Deans must recognize that their work should be passed on despite changes in membership and endeavor to record the standards and circumstances of their decisions.

2. Deans must endeavor to document procedures so that the administrative work for which they are responsible does not depend on a particular individual.

Article 8. Where there is more than one Dean, they must share information and cooperate in performing their duties.

Article 9. The Deans separately establish provisions needed to implement this chapter.

Chapter 6 Lecturers

Article 1. This chapter establishes the necessary provisions concerning Lecturer status and related matters, in accordance with the principles of the Charter.

Article 2. A Student may become a Lecturer by agreeing to the following matters, submitting the prescribed application, and receiving approval.

(1) The Academy may use and distribute course materials created by that Student free of charge, to the extent necessary for activities within the Academy.

(2) The Student will comply with the separately established guidelines concerning Lecturers.

2. The approval referred to in the preceding paragraph requires the unanimous agreement of the Deans.

3. The application procedure referred to in paragraph 1 is established separately.

Article 3. Lecturers may determine the content, structure, and conduct of their courses at their own discretion.

Article 4. Lecturers must endeavor to conduct their courses in good faith.

Article 5. Matters concerning loss of Lecturer status are governed by Chapter 2, Article 7 and Chapter 8.

Article 6. The Deans separately establish provisions needed to implement this chapter.

Chapter 7 Courses

Article 1. This chapter establishes the necessary provisions concerning the conduct of courses, in accordance with the principles of the Charter.

Article 2. The Academy has a Rhythm Games Foundations Faculty and a Rhythm Games Practice Faculty.

2. The course categories within each Faculty are as follows.

(1) Rhythm Games Foundations Faculty: Creation; Humanities and Sciences.

(2) Rhythm Games Practice Faculty: Arcade; Standalone; Mobile.

Article 3. The Rhythm Games Foundations Faculty covers knowledge, culture, and creation relating to rhythm games.

(1) Creation: fields involving art, design, development, and other forms of creation.

(2) Humanities and Sciences: fields within the humanities, social sciences, and natural sciences.

Article 4. The Rhythm Games Practice Faculty covers skills and knowledge relating to playing rhythm games.

(1) Arcade: fields relating to rhythm games played on cabinets installed in arcades and other premises.

(2) Standalone: fields relating to rhythm games running on home consoles, computers, and other equipment.

(3) Mobile: fields relating to rhythm games running on mobile devices.

Article 5. The Faculties and course categories specified in the preceding two Articles are guides for finding courses and do not limit the scope of Students' activities.

2. For a course spanning several categories, the principal category is selected.

3. For a course that is difficult to place in any category, the closest category is selected. In such cases, Deans provide advice on choosing a category.

Article 6. A Lecturer may open a course by submitting the prescribed application and receiving approval.

2. The approval referred to in the preceding paragraph requires the unanimous agreement of the Deans.

3. The specific application procedure referred to in paragraph 1 is established separately.

Article 7. Students may take courses in accordance with separately established provisions.

2. A Lecturer may set conditions for taking their course. In that case, the Lecturer must make those conditions known in advance to Students wishing to take it.
3. Where course registration is required to take a course, the procedures concerning the method of registration, when it takes effect, changes, and cancellation are established separately.
4. Access to course registration and participation records is limited to the Lecturer responsible for the course and Deans who need access for administrative work. Use of those records is limited to what is necessary to identify participants, change or cancel registrations, communicate as required to run the course, and enable the Lecturer to record participation and assessments.
5. Course registration and assessment records kept by a Lecturer do not constitute the Academy's formal recognition of grades or credits. The system for grades and credits is established separately.

Article 8. Copyright and other intellectual property rights in course materials belong to the Lecturer who created them.

2. Notwithstanding the preceding paragraph, on the basis of the consent referred to in Chapter 6, Article 2, paragraph 1, item (1), the Academy may use and distribute course materials free of charge to the extent necessary for activities within the Academy.

Article 9. If a Lecturer has difficulty conducting the planned number of course sessions during the regular activity period, the remaining sessions may be conducted during the make-up period.

Article 10. Deans may ask a Lecturer to discontinue or change a course only when they determine that facts falling within one of the following items exist.

- (1) The communication of clearly false information or other facts that seriously undermine the integrity of the course.
 - (2) Harassment or other seriously improper conduct toward participants or other Students.
 - (3) In addition to the preceding two items, facts that are considered to pose a risk of seriously harming Students' rights or interests.
2. A request under the preceding paragraph must be limited to the minimum necessary so as not to unduly restrict the academic freedom provided for in the Charter.

Article 11. The Deans separately establish provisions needed to implement this chapter.

Chapter 8 Removal from Office and Disciplinary Measures

Article 1. This chapter establishes the necessary provisions concerning the resignation and removal of officeholders and disciplinary measures against Students, including officeholders, in accordance with the principles of the Charter.

Article 2. An officeholder other than the Director may resign at any time by notifying the Director.

2. The Director may resign at any time by notifying the Deans.

Article 3. If the Director determines that an officeholder other than the Director falls within either of the following items, the Director may remove that officeholder from office after consultation among the Deans.

(1) The officeholder is unable to perform their duties, thereby hindering the smooth operation of the Academy.

(2) Harassment or other seriously improper conduct toward other Students makes the officeholder unfit to be entrusted with the duties of the office.

2. If the Deans determine that the Director falls within either item of the preceding paragraph, they may remove the Director from office through consultation.

3. Removal under the preceding two paragraphs does not replace disciplinary measures under this chapter. Where the Deans consider it necessary, they may impose disciplinary measures separately under this chapter.

Article 4. A Student may be subject to disciplinary measures for conduct falling within any of the following items.

(1) Conduct in violation of the Charter or these Regulations.

(2) Harassment or other seriously improper conduct toward other Students.

(3) False statements or other fraudulent conduct in applications or notifications.

(4) Conduct that seriously damages the Academy's reputation or credibility.

(5) Conduct in violation of the terms of use of an external service used as a platform for the Academy's activities that hinders those activities.

(6) In addition to the preceding items, conduct that seriously harms other Students' rights or interests.

Article 5. Where the Deans determine that facts falling within any item of the preceding Article exist, they may impose the following disciplinary measures on the Student concerned.

- (1) Warning.
- (2) Suspension of activities: suspension of all or part of the Student's activities within the Academy for a specified period.
- (3) Expulsion.

Article 6. As a general rule, disciplinary measures are imposed progressively, in the order of warning, suspension of activities, and expulsion.

2. If the Deans determine that a Student who has received a warning again engages in conduct falling within any item of Article 4 during the same academic term, they may impose suspension of activities.
3. If the Deans determine that a Student who has received suspension of activities again engages in conduct falling within any item of Article 4 during or after the suspension period, they may impose expulsion.

Article 7. Notwithstanding the preceding Article, where the Deans determine that an exceptionally serious violation has occurred, they may immediately impose suspension of activities or expulsion without first issuing a warning.

Article 8. If the Deans determine that a Student's conduct is causing harm to order within the Academy or to the safety of other Students, or poses an imminent risk of such harm, they may take emergency measures to the extent necessary, such as temporarily restricting that Student's access to activities within the Academy, without imposing disciplinary measures under Articles 5 to 7.

2. When a measure under the preceding paragraph is taken, the Deans must notify the Student concerned of the reasons without delay.
3. A measure under paragraph 1 ceases to have effect no later than the last day of the academic term in which it was taken.
4. A measure under paragraph 1 does not replace disciplinary measures under this chapter. Where the Deans consider it necessary, they may impose disciplinary measures separately under this chapter.

Article 9. A Student may appeal to the Deans against removal from office under Article 3, a measure under the preceding Article, or a disciplinary measure under this chapter.

2. An appeal under the preceding paragraph is reviewed by Deans other than those who made the removal, emergency measure, or disciplinary decision concerned.

Article 10. The Deans separately establish provisions needed to implement this chapter.

Chapter 9 Amendment of the Regulations

Article 1. This chapter establishes the necessary provisions concerning procedures for adopting, amending, and repealing these Regulations, in accordance with the principles of the Charter.

Article 2. A Dean may propose the adoption, amendment, or repeal of these Regulations.

Article 3. When making a proposal under the preceding Article, the Dean must seek Students' views as necessary.

Article 4. The adoption, amendment, or repeal of these Regulations takes effect when the proposer has notified the other Deans in advance.

Article 5. When these Regulations are adopted, amended, or repealed, the Director must promptly announce this to Students.

Article 6. The Deans separately establish provisions needed to implement this chapter.

Supplementary provisions

1. These Regulations take effect on 1 September 2026.
2. Notwithstanding Chapter 2, Article 3, people already engaged in the Academy's administration when these Regulations take effect are deemed to have been appointed as Deans, unless they do not wish to be appointed.

History

- Adopted on 29 August 2026.
- Amended on 30 August 2026.
- Amended on 1 October 2026 (provisional date in the Japanese working text).